

RBI Financial Fraud Prevention Handbook

Overview

Digital banking has increased convenience but also created opportunities for cybercriminals. Consumers must remain vigilant.

Common Types of Fraud

Phishing

Fake emails requesting confidential information.

Smishing

Fraudulent SMS messages containing malicious links.

Vishing

Fraudulent phone calls impersonating banks.

Investment Fraud

Promises of unrealistic returns.

Loan App Fraud

Unauthorized lending applications collecting personal data.

QR Code Fraud

Scammers trick users into scanning codes that trigger payments.

Warning Signs

- Guaranteed profits
- Urgent payment requests
- Requests for OTP
- Requests for card PIN
- Requests for CVV

Banking Safety Tips

- Use official banking applications
- Enable two-factor authentication
- Update passwords regularly
- Avoid public Wi-Fi for banking

Cyber Hygiene

- Keep devices updated
- Install antivirus software
- Download apps only from official stores
- Monitor account activity frequently

Reporting Fraud

National Cyber Crime Portal: www.cybercrime.gov.in
Cyber Helpline: 1930

RBI Recommendations

- Verify before you trust
- Think before you click
- Never share banking credentials

Case Study

A fraudster impersonates a bank officer and requests OTP verification. The customer shares OTP and loses funds. This demonstrates why OTP must never be shared.

Key Takeaways

- RBI never asks for passwords
- Banks never ask for PINs
- Genuine institutions never request OTPs